



SWAPNIL ASNODKAR (JAIPUR)
Matches: 9 Runs: 311
Avg: 34.55

ROHIT SHARMA (HYDERABAD)
Matches: 13 Runs: 404
Avg: 36.72

AMIT MISHRA (DELHI)
Matches: 6 Wkts: 11
Avg: 12.33

cause no questions have been asked. Everyone is waiting for Sharad Pawar to go away." Pawar takes over as ICC president in just over a year but first, the BCCI's own elections are on in September. Manohar may have been named president-elect but there are several other posts up for the vote. The next few months will witness grim, silent power tussle—and Dalmiya will somehow be involved. Granting that the IPL had staying power, the old fox took a swipe at its format saying it could lead to "a lot of speculation and betting".

The IPL's biggest challenge will come from its own success; any attempt to channelise growth will be met with resistance and conflict from increasingly ambitious franchises, owners of the IPL's biggest assets—its teams and players.

On semi-finals eve in Mumbai along with anticipation, a disquiet mingled in the air. The IPL was winding down and its worker bees, none older than 45 it seemed, had time to think about what they had wrought. One commented, "It's been a great event but I don't know if it's good for cricket."

This was no Lord's loving-nostalgic stuck in the 1950s. He could have been a prototype for the young, aspirational, global Indian, carrying a buzzing Blackberry, wearing the latest in linen and loafers. Monopolies of any kind, he knew, were unhealthy and the IPL will only skew the power equations in cricket even more towards the financial behemoth that is India. Besides, the BCCI's track record for sagacity and leadership remains unimpressive and Lalit Modi's is not the first name that springs to mind to be a custodian of cricket.

Watching a multi-national television crew put up their rig yet again, another industry regular dressed in khaki cutoffs and running shoes, said he had taken 19 flights in 44 days, which sometimes felt like 44 flights in 19. The IPL's success was ringing in his ears, the bosses were pleased, his bank balance was even happier. As the first of the floodlights' silver beams cut through the dusk and Gautam Gambhir joshed with Glenn McGrath, he said, "This is our Frankenstein, we made it and now it's left the room." **with Elora Sen.**

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India u-19s stars played; Pradeep Sangwan (Del) got the most matches, 7.



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